Typing Practice – II

1. Speed Practice from Printed Matter : (15 minutes)

(a) The present constitution of India was framed by the Constitution Assembly of India set up under the Cabinet Mission Plan of May16, 1946. The idea of establishing a Constituent Assembly to draw up the Indian Constitution was not a new one. The American Constitution was framed by a Constitution Assembly. In fact, American Constitution has proved to be a model to the democratic world. Till independence, India was governed under the Acts passed by the British Parliament. In 1938 Sri Jawaharlal Lal Nehru declared: "The Indian National Congress stands for independence and a democratic state. It has proposed that the constitution of free India must be framed, without outside interference, by a constituent assembly elected on the basis of adult franchise. That is the democratic way and there is no other way short of revolution, which can bring the needed result. An assembly so elected will represent the people as a whole and will be far more interested in the economic and social problems of the masses than in the petty communal issues which affect small groups . "

The inaugural meeting of the Constituent Assembly of India was held on December 9,1946. It was presided over by Dr.Sachchidananda Sinha who was the oldest member of the Assembly. On December 11, 1946, Dr. Rajendra Prasad was elected President of the Constituent Assembly.

On December 13, 1946, Shri Jawahar Lal Nehru moved the "objectives resolution" which later became the Preamble of the Constitution.

A number of committees submitted reports to the Constituent Assembly on the different aspects of the constitution. On the basis of these reports the constitution was prepared by Constitutional Adviser, Sri B. N. Rao. The Drafting Committee under the chairmanship of Dr.Ambedkar worked on the draft and produced the Draft Constitution with 315 articles and 8 schedules. The Draft Constitution was considered by the Constituent Assembly. In its progress through the Constituent Assembly, the constitution grew in bulk and took its final shape with 395 articles and 8 schedules. The time taken in accomplishing this task was exactly two years, eleven months and 17 days from the first meeting of Constituent Assembly on 9th December, 1946 till November 26, 1949 when "We, the people of India" gave unto ourselves the new constitution.

There have been over 92 amendments to our Constitution so far.

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